Lesson 33

LAST DAYS SERIES Part1: HOPE

Aim: To study the scriptural meaning and basis of hope and its importance in the life of a believer.

Introduction:

"Once you choose hope, anything is possible" - Christopher Reeve

"Hope is the little voice you hear whisper, maybe when the entire world is shouting NO!" - Anonymous

Hope is a very vital ingredient in our Christian experience. Without hope we are living aimlessly and carelessly. Hope, like an anchor, hives ability to a ship. In this study, we will try to explore the implications of hope in our lives as believers of Jesus Christ.

I. WHAT IS HOPE?

This is used to express a desire or expectation concerning the future that is often nothing more than wishful thinking or holding on mere possibility. But “Christian Hope" is more than "wishful thinking" because it is based on something

definite and solid- Word of God. Hope is a positive factor in our Christian lives.

II. WHAT ARE SOME OBJECTS OF OUR BLESSED HOPE?

A. Second Coming of Christ

Titus 2:13 - *13while we wait for the blessed hope—the appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior, Jesus Christ,*

B. The Resurrection of the Dead

1. Cor. 15:12-22 - *12But if it is preached that Christ has been raised from the dead, how can some of you say that there is no resurrection of the dead? 13If there is no resurrection of the dead, then not even Christ has been raised. 14And if Christ has not been raised, our preaching is useless and so is your faith. 15More than that, we are then found to be false witnesses about God, for we have testified about God that he raised Christ from the dead. But he did not raise him if in fact the dead are not raised. 16For if the dead are not raised, then Christ has not been raised either. 17And if Christ has not been raised, your faith is futile; you are still in your sins. 18Then those also who have fallen asleep in Christ are lost. 19If only for this*

life we have hope in Christ, we are of all people most to be pitied. 20 But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the first fruits of those who have fallen asleep. 21For since death came through a man, the resurrection of the dead comes also through a man. 22For as in Adam all die, so in Christ all will be made alive.

C. Glory.

Romans 8:18 - *18I consider that our present sufferings are not worth comparing with the glory that will be revealed in us.*

Col. 1:27 - *27To them God has chosen to make known among the Gentiles the glorious riches of this mystery, which is Christ in you, the hope of glory.*

D. Heaven.

2 Peter 3:13- *13But in keeping with his promise we are looking forward to a new heaven and a new earth, where righteousness dwells.*

E. Millennial Reign

Rev. 20:6- 6Blessed and holy are those who share in the first resurrection. The second death has no power over them, but they will be priests of God and of Christ and will reign with him for a thousand years.

F. Heavenly Reward.

2 Timothy 4:8- *4In the presence of God and of Christ Jesus, who will judge the living and the dead, and in view of his appearing and his kingdom, I give you this charge: 2Preach the word; be prepared in season and out of season; correct, rebuke and encourage—with great patience and careful instruction. 3For the time will come when people will not put up with sound doctrine. Instead, to suit their own desires, they will gather around them a great number of teachers to say what their itching ears want to hear. 4They will turn their ears away from the truth and turn aside to myths. 5But you, keep your head in all situations, endure hardship, do the work of an evangelist, discharge all the duties of your ministry. 6For I am already being poured out like a drink offering, and the time for my departure is near. 7I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. 8Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day—and not only to me, but also to all who have longed for his appearing.*

III. WHAT DOES HOPE PRODUCE IN US?

A. Confidence.

John 11:8 - *"But Rabbi," they said, "a short while ago the Jews there tried to stone you, and yet you are going back?"*

B. Gladness

Prov. 10:28 - *The prospect of the righteous is joy, but the hopes of the wicked come to nothing.*

C. Faith.

Hebrews 11:1- *Now faith is being sure of what we hope for and certain of what we do not see.*

D. Purity.

1 John 3:3 - *3All who have this hope in him purify themselves, just as he is pure.*

E. Strength.

Psalm 31:24 - *24Be strong and take heart, all you who hope in the LORD.*

F. Anchor/ Stability

Hebrews 6:18,19- *18God did this so that, by two unchangeable things in which it is impossible for God to lie, we who have fled to take hold of the hope set before us may be greatly encouraged.19We have this hope as an anchor for the soul, firm and secure. It enters the inner sanctuary behind the curtain,*

CONCLUSION

Christians can always be joyful because of their blessed Hope in Christ.